

Catherine Wah

 [catherinewah](#) |  [catherinewah.com](#) |  Scholar |  catherine.wah@gmail.com |  217.377.5120

SUMMARY

Engineering leader dedicated to building high-performing teams and bringing advanced AI research to life. I foster a culture of ownership, mutual respect, and accountability where teams are empowered to solve complex problems and deliver results in challenging, fast-paced environments.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Manager, Google Workspace 2023–present

- Led a 25-person org in building AI-powered features across Workspace, in particular for Slides and [Vids](#)
- Key cross-Workspace leader for a critical business area (Generative Imagery); served as DRI for sprint to launch [Nano Banana Pro in Workspace](#), resulting in a multi-fold increase in traffic and millions in user adoption
- Doubled org size and cultivated a high-velocity collaborative team that delivered applied ML features like [Imagen 4 for Workspace](#), [image background removal](#), and [Gemini for Slides](#), which supports prompt-based slide generation, image suggestions for your slide, summarization, Q&A, etc.

Technical Lead/Manager, Google Shopping 2022–2023

Led an advanced research team focusing on ML-based image synthesis for [virtual try-on of apparel](#)

Technical Lead/Manager, Google Assistant 2018–2021

- Led a team in improving developer tooling for supporting on-device natural language understanding
- Launched on-device NLU in Assistant to a new surface ([Android Auto](#)) across multiple countries

Software Engineer, Google Photos 2014–2018

- Drove design/implementation for generating suggested recipients for [Suggested Sharing](#) features
- Developed personalized ranking algorithms for [Things Explore tiles](#) as part of initial Photos launch

Technical Lead, Google.org Software Engineering Fellow Sep 2021 - Mar 2022

- Embedded directly within a [non-profit organization](#) as part of a 6-month engagement. Led a cross-functional Google team in building a unified data platform solution that enabled the non-profit to connect more US residents to benefits (est. \$1.2M annual increase in received benefits)

EDUCATION

- 2014 PhD (Computer Science) at **University of California, San Diego (UCSD)**
Advised by Serge Belongie; specialized in computer vision (fine-grained visual categorization). Published at top-tier computer vision conferences (CVPR, IJCV, ICCV, ECCV)
Supported by NSF Graduate Research Fellowship, UCSD Powell Foundation Fellowship, NSF [IRIE](#)
- 2011 M.S. (Computer Science) at **UCSD**
- 2008 B.S. (Electrical Engineering), at **University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)**
Minors in Computer Science and Mathematics
Awards: [Knight of St Patrick](#), Senior 100 Honorary, Ellery B. Paine Outstanding Junior Award

OTHER

- 2024–present AI advisor for [Google.org Generative AI Accelerator program](#), supporting non-profit organizations supporting non-profit organizations [Quill](#) and [iNaturalist](#) in using GenAI to address significant societal problems. Continue to serve on [Quill advisory board](#)
- 2024–present Technical mentor to growth-stage/AI-First startups in [Google for Startups Accelerators](#)
- 2013–present Reviewer for top-tier computer vision/machine learning conferences/journals, including NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, ICCV, IJCV, CVPR
- 2022–2024 Director, [Women in Machine Learning \(WiML\)](#)
- 2013–2017 Program Committee Member, *Fine-Grained Visual Categorization (FGVC) Workshop*